



ES ERNTFESCHT UN DER ZISASEGE 19. SCHEIDING, 2015

ROBERT LUSCH (MIT DENKI ZUM BRIAN WEIS)
REV-D1

Honoring: Dunner (Thor), Siwwa (Sif), Idunn, Owwerne (Matronae), Zisa

Intonation of the Runes

Each rune intoned thrice: Thurisaz, Jera, Naudhiz, Wunjo, Perthro, Tiwaz

Die Heiliching - The Hallowing

*Hammer, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell
Beschitz uns mit der Graft vun de Ziewe
Bei Wudan un Freid fer der Gemeeschaft zu baue
Bei Ziu un Zisa fer die Gerechdichkeit un der Fruchsfriede zu erhalde
Bei Frey un Freya fer die Wohldaat zu schneide un zu sammle
Bei Dunner un Siwwa fer es Volk vollzumechtige.
Bei der Idunn un de Owwerne fer es Volk zu erneire
Wie der Hammer schmittet die Sichel,
So die Sichel der Hammer fiedert.
'S iss es Lewesraad: zu saehe un zu schneide
Hammer, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell*

Heel!

Heel!

Heel!

Unser Zweck - Our Purpose

Heit sammle mir uns do, fer die Ernt zu feiere un aa fer die Ziewe zu ehre.

Die Ziewe, die Wichde, es Land, un unser hattes Schaffe henn uns en groossi Wohldaat gschenkt. Heel zu der Wohldaat! Hail to the Harvest!

*Heel zu de Ziewe!
Heel zu de Wichde!
Heel zum Land!
Heel zu der Gmeeschaft!*

Der Aaruf - The Invocation

Idunn!
Abbel-Draagern!
Yuchend-Bewaarern!
Em Braag sei Luschde!
Em Thjazi sei verlangdi Nuss!

Siwwa!
Goldehaarichi Haerrin!
Fraa vun der Kaern!
Em Brokk sei Schatzfund!
Em Dunner sei beliebt!

Dunner!
Yedermannszieb!
Meeschder vum Schtarem!
Em Dreizehdax sei Fluch!
Der Siwwa ihre Luschde!

Zisa!
Gnacklosbinnern!
Haerrin vum Zizarim!
Fraa vun de Beintzabbe

Owwerne!
Wohldaatsweiwer
Volkschitzerinne!

Liewe Ziewe!
Mir bidde Eich mit uns zu bsuche
Un mit uns heit unseri Frehlichkeit zu feiere
Seid unsere verehrte Gaschde
So kammer mit Eich unseri Liewe,
unseri Freindschaft,
un unseri Wohldaat verdeele!

Heele!

Idunna!
Apple-Bearer
Protectress of Youth
Delight of Bragi
Desired Nut of Thjazi!

Sif!
Golden-Haired Lady!
Lady of the Grain!
Treasure Trove of Brokk!
Beloved of Thor!

Thor!
God of the Everyman!
Master of the Storm
Bane of Dreizehdax!
Delight of Sif!

Zisa!
Untier-of-Knots!
Lady of Zizarim!
Lady of the Pine Cones

Matronae!
Ladies of Bounty!
Protectors of the Folk!

Dear Gods and Goddesses!
We bid You to visit with us
And to celebrate with us our joy today!
Be our honored Guests
So we can share with you our love
Our kinship,
And our bounty.

Hail!

Idunna Leseschtick - Idunna Reading

From *Skáldskaparmál 1* in the *Prose Edda*.

Siwwa Leseschtick - Sif Leseschtick

Based on the *Skáldskaparmál* in the *Prose Edda*.

Zisa Poem

You call to me from a place afar
How little I know of who You are.
Step closer to me, my heart so yearns
So I can see You, know You and learn.
Oh You, dear Lady, undoer of knots
Undo the ignorance that time has wrought.
Reveal Yourself and show the way
That I can walk with You, day by day.

-- Lewen Worrell, May 2009

Es Opfer un Die Eed - The Offering and the Oaths

*Losst uns enniche Opfer uff der Aldaar adder in 's Feier yetz schtelle
Un wann ennichebber hot en Eed zu bschweere, kumm yetz voraa.*

*If anyone has any offerings, please place them onto the altar, or, later, into the fire.
If anyone has any oaths to take, come forward now.*

Die Heiliching vun de Opfer - The Hallowing of the Offerings

*Liewe Ziewe!
Heit hemmer dese Opfer fer Eich gsammelt.
Mir henn aa annere Dinger wie Schenkunge eigsammelt.
Losst die Schekunge gude Daade mache, die uns, Eich, un der Urglaawe gut schpiggle warre.
Heel!*

Die Ausdeeling - The Distribution

Darrich die do Gedrenke deele mir uns in de Heilich Grafte vun de Ziewe, vun unsere Voreldre, un vun nanne.

Through this libation we share in the holy energies of the deities, of our elders, and of each other.

Der Sege - The Blessing

When pouring the libations, all say (choose either language):

*Vun de Ziewe zu der Erd zu uns
Vun uns zu der Erd zu de Gedder*

*From the gods to the Earth to us
From us to the Earth to the gods*

*'N Gschenk fer 'n Gschenk
Heele!*

*A gift for a gift.
Hail!*

Zum Schluss - In Closing

*Heit sedde mir uns feiere!
Luschedert mol die Sunne un die warremi Luft
Es Gleichgewicht iss ball zu passiere!
Der Summer gebt sich zum Harebscht ei.*

*Today we should celebrate!
Enjoy the sun and the warm air!
The equinox is soon to pass.
Summer gives itself in to Fall.*

Der Sege iss beschlosse waerre.

This Sege is closed.

Zu de Wichde - To the Wights

Thor Song

This great song by Leslie Fish was originally written to call for a break to the dry weather in the West years ago. Our intention when singing it, though, is to sing a powerful song of Thor.

Because we sang this song at Philadelphia Pagan Pride, we may decide to improvise and to come up with something entirely new today on the fly.

Sammel - Sumble

THOR SONG
by Leslie Fish

----- Refrain -----

Hail Thor!
Lord of Thunders!
Master of the Winds of the Western World!
Hail Thor!
Hammer Wielder!
Lord of Lightning, Lord of Storm!

Bring the wind that bears the waters!
Master of the Winds of the Western World!
Call the cloud and all it utters!
Lord of Lightning, Lord of Storms!

Fetch the flock of cloud-sheep grazing!
Master of the Winds of the Western World!
Lift the lash of lightning blazing!
Lord of Lightning, Lord of Storms!

In your arms the waters gather!
Master of the Winds of the Western world!
Whip the waves to rage and lather!
Lord of Lightning, Lord of Storms!

Draw the drops of the sky together!
Master of the Winds of the Western World!
Break the back of burning weather!
Lord of Lightning, Lord of Storms!

Join our joy of feast and singing!
Master of the Winds of the Western World!
Set the sky with laughter ringing!
Lord of Lightning, Lord of Storms!

DISCUSSION TOPICS

We could talk about the deities we honor at Erntfescht all day, particularly because Dunner/Thor is so well known. However, for discussion, we are going to focus on the lesser-known aspects of the observance.

ERNTFESCHT

The Harvest Home is a long-standing Germanic tradition of celebrating the harvest. At this time, community and families would help to ensure that their neighbors and relatives would have food to prepare for the coming winter. Families would exchange different crops from farms and gardens. The tradition was observed by different tribes and in different regions at different times, but the tradition continued through the Christian era and is very much alive, particularly in Eastern Pennsylvania, even today.

EDELMUT (Generosity)

Several virtues are tied closely to the Harvest Home; perhaps foremost among them in the post-modern era is Generosity. Heathen principles contain the concept of "a gift for a gift," so a gift from a Heathen is met by a return gift, even if the values of the gifts are not equal. This principle is an aspect of Fruchsfriede (frith) and of open lines of communication, thus signaling peace between the two parties.

What of the community outside of the Heathens, though? Fruchsfriede indicates that we have a responsibility to everyone. Foremost are our children, spouses, kinfolk, and then we move to more distant family, friends, and acquaintances. Simply by being a part of the human community, we owe even strangers some frith.

There are numerous ways to go about being generous to the wider community. For starters, compulsion from the government does not constitute generosity, so we will omit that aspect of giving from the discussion. Is giving a quarter to a beggar on the street generous, or is it likely that the quarter will go towards something more destructive? Why do we give food donations in lieu of monetary donations? Are food donations enabling those who are living beyond their means to continue to do so, or are they food donations covering a gap for people in a time of need? If a gift demands a gift, are we setting the recipients up for an impact on their Wurd (Wyrd) by not providing them a means for returning the gift?

These are questions we will discuss.

AUSDAUER (in the Perseverance sense)

"Ausdauer" has several connotations in Deutsch; for example, "perseverance" and "steadfastness." We all have had many challenges in the past year, some of which we have been coping and struggling with for many months. Our discussion will reflect on the need to persevere and to move forward in life, recognizing the changes, gains, and losses we have experienced. ZISASEGE

Zisa is seen as the founder and protector of the city of Augsburg in modern Bavaria. Augsburg was known earlier as Zizarim. Fraa Zisa was reported under various names (including Isis due to language confusion, apparently). She was particularly associated with the Suevi, who are the predecessors of the Swabians. The Suevi also mixed with the Alemanni and other tribes. There are quite a few locations in southern Germany and Switzerland named for Her. The tribes who knew Her were large contributors to the Pennsylvania German nation.

In the first century BCE, the Romans under Titus Annius laid siege to Zizarim just before Her feast day. Unfortunately for the Romans, many Swabian warriors were coming to Zizarim for the festival, and on Her day they attacked the Romans and throttled them.

Granted, the Romans years later did take the city, but the battle for Zizarim was a famous loss for Rome. Despite the loss of the city and the subsequent Christian suppression, Her presence remained.

Zisa in the Christian era was depicted as the Virgin Mary with the extra appellation of "Undoer-of-Knots." Images of Her from later centuries indicate that she has the ability to remove obstacles or even to undo Urleeg if one's cause is just. Images of Her in this role have been restored in Augsburg's city hall, though the were from later centuries originally.

She was so widely revered among the Suevi that their dialects called Tuesday "Zistag" not after Zio but after Her. The Diocese of Augsburg banned the name Zistag and called it "Aftermontag" (After-Monday).

There are quite a few places that bear her name as the root of their modern names. The church of St. Peter am Perlach stands on the grounds of Her temple at Zisenberg in Augsburg.

Her symbol is the pinecone and appears in Augsburg even in some churches. As the pine cone protects the seeds, so does she protect her people. The pinecone symbolizes protection, regeneration, and continuity. Even though Augsburg was eventually conquered by the Romans, the Volk's relationship to Zisa continued, in symbolic form if not conscious form, into the present day.

The pinecone even now appears on the coat of arms of Augsburg.



MATRONAE: Now called "Owwerne" or "Hausmidder" in Deutsch. These are goddesses (or, perhaps, matriarchal spirits?) to whom numerous altars were set up throughout the Continental Germanic region. Over 1100 such altars, stones, plaques, etc. are known to exist. Many, if not most, of the altars were votive stones erected by someone as an expression of thanks for a gift or a success attributed to the Matronae. Many of the votives feature three ladies, each of whom holds some sort of agricultural bounty, particularly what appear to be apples. More and more knowledge and insight is emerging these days, and we will continue to honor more of Them. Tonight we will specifically honor the Vesuniahena, who are Matronae associated with a place called Vettweiss in the North Rhine-Westphalia state of Germany.

For more information on the Matronae, please see this blog article written by our friend and colleague, River Devora: <http://polytheist.com/the-web-of-blessings/2015/08/12/the-matronae-and-matres-breathing-new-life-into-an-old-religion/>

Also, we do discuss the Matronae on the Urglaawe group on Facebook: <https://www.facebook.com/groups/Urglaawe/>